3.3.2. Objectives of Office Layout:

The objectives of an office lay out are:

1. The available floor space should be used to the greatest extent
2. Service such as electricity and telephone should be available wherever needed
3. Good working conditions should be provided for everyone.
4. The individual clerks should be so located that the supervisor should be able to see the staff at work.
5. A sense of belonging and loyalty to the working group should be encouraged
6. Communication and work flow should be facilitated
7. The movement of clerks between desks, filing cabinets, etc should be made easy. The work desks should be located within easy reach of equipment and machines which the clerk may need to use in course of performing the work.
8. Noisy and distracting operations should be segregated.
9. Mutual interference between clerks should be avoided.
10. Privacy and security should be provided to departments or individuals dealing with work of confidential documents or records.
11. Adequate safety arrangements should be provided for departments dealing with secret or valuable documents or records.

3.3.3. Importance of Office Layout:

A well planned layout brings a number of benefits to the office and to the employees. The benefits of proper office layout is given below:

1) Assists in the efficiency of getting the work done from employees.
2) Proper utilization of office floor space.
3) Facilitates smooth supervision.
4) Speeds up intercommunication.
5) Utilization of office machines and equipment to their optimum capacity.
6) Ensures better comfort and self esteem of the employees.

3.4 Open Office and Private Office:

3.4.1. Open Office:

The modern tendency is to adopt the open office instead of accommodating departments or sections in separate rooms. An open office refers to a large room where all the departments, men and equipment are housed under a single roof without partitions or walls separating them. Each department or section is allotted a separate space in the same room, which is often separated by placing filing cabinets between them. One or more passage throughout the whole floor may be provided and desks may be arranged facing one way so as to facilitate supervision and easy access.

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